

The individual, society & history

↳ E H Carr

penicillium - first commercially produced antibiotic

— history —————> Good ppl
|
bad ppl

→ what came first: Individual or society
we are shaped by our surroundings
→ our mannerism, mother tongue → conditioned by society

→ the process of being social being from biological beings.

→ the interdependence grows with growing complexity.

→ as society become complex their components are more connected
→ two way process
individual make society
society shapes individuals

↓ simple economy
farmer grows & sell
↓ complex
growing → group, talk, global talk

The cult of individualism

Renaissance — rebirth 15-16 century, heaven

→ French, European → dark ages inherit Spiritualism

↓ darkness on earth

It shapes so much their architecture

→ domes displaced

→ pointing to up (heaven) (all answers can be found in heaven)

↑ spikes
Renaissance

→ within domes → humanism

we need to look into man for answers

→ humans are center of everything
Individual → being Important

later rise of capitalism, protestantism

Individual
private & own
Control property

↓
good personal
relation with faith
religion

Influenced by utilitarianism
Individuals ~~act~~ act in
their self-interest
while contributing
to society's well-being
pursue happiness
society also for the sake of
Individuals

actions based on
their ability to
maximize overall
happiness

→ Individual not against society

→ Individualism doesn't mean rejecting
society but rather emphasizing personal
freedom within it
→ need society

historian

history is written by individuals about
individuals

→ procession → moving forward in history
→ historian is a part of this
→ historian's position in the procession determines
their writings

historians

- historians may change their views if procession change (self-changing)
- ↳ change position in processing along time.
- ↳ product spokesman of his society

↓
who is influenced by → speaks about it

- personality determines their angle of vision of the past

19th century (British)

- ↳ colonial power, imperial power, progress
- Bigger & better time, prosperity

→ Cycles in history

↑
EH care → before you study history, study historian
↓
↳ to know why they're writing about it
↳ circumstance decide ~~how~~ what they write.

great man theory of history → history shaped by

→ why they doing that, ex: Asoka, Gandhi

↳ individual genius

→ historians choose what is important to them

Cambridge school of historians

↳ wrote about Gandhi → why he does that

what does the rules, why he need implement

↳ how he pull off ~~masses~~ ~~to~~ ~~the~~

those over mountain empire
→ non-cooperation, quite india

Mehru & Patel → Shape after Independence.
Rajendra Prasad - Bihar - travel through Bihar and
Role of individual promote national movement

great man become center of study
↳ this

Is history the stuff of individual genius?
→ no, because if there is no colonial rule
of British on India Gandhi might not be
the historical great man so, history is
not result of personal genius but a
structural & collective forces.

Is the theory essentially escapist?

Yes, since it doesn't tell anything about
social forces that make the individual the
great

→ blaming or crediting individuals rather than
engaging with structural realities that
shape society.

great
men

Can the behaviour of men as individuals separated
from as members of groups?

Yes, any leader leading a group of people
acts on the basis of advises, followers,
social conditions their behaviour was different
from isolation

ex: Gandhi

how do we understand dissidents & rebels in history?

→ some face ~~the~~ opposition, persecution, marginalization, yet in hindsight they were recognized as heroes, while others remain controversial or forgotten

Do great men lie outside history?

No,